

Chicago Tribune



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SUNDAY, OCTOBER 5, 2025

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Trump OKs calling up 300 Guard troops

Pritzker objects to move, says president's administration issued ultimatum: 'Call up your troops, or we will'



Federal officers detain a person while members of the community and activists protest near the 3900 block of South Kedzie Avenue in Chicago's Brighton Park neighborhood on Saturday. **ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

**By Jeremy Gornier,
Gregory Royal Pratt
and Rick Pearson**
Chicago Tribune

President Donald Trump authorized a historic federalized deployment of 300 National Guard members Saturday to the Chicago area over the objections of Democratic Gov. JB Pritzker, with the White House saying it was needed to protect federal officers and assets conducting immigration enforcement amid "ongoing violent riots and lawlessness."

But Pritzker and the state's leading Democrats accused Trump of further escalating chaos and fear by utilizing a military deployment of National Guard members to support the controversial actions of U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement and Border Patrol officers already deployed in its aggressive "Operation Midway Blitz."

Ironically, Trump was silent on Saturday about the deployment after months of mocking Chicago and Pritzker, a vehement critic of the president, over the city's crime problems and threatening a federalization and mobilization of National Guard troops to the nation's third-largest city. Trump made no statement or comment on his Truth Social social media network about the deployment as of Saturday evening.

Instead, it was Pritzker who said he had been given an ultimatum from Trump's Department of Defense: "Call up your troops, or we will."

"It is absolutely outrageous and un-American to demand a Governor send military troops within our own borders and against our will," Pritzker said in a statement, adding that he believed it was Illinois National Guard members who were the troops being mobilized.

Turn to Troops, Page 2

IN CHICAGOLAND: A federal judge in Chicago is set to rule on alleged ICE violations in Trump's "Operation Midway Blitz." **Page 3**

■ Federal agents on Saturday morning shoot a woman they accuse of "boxing in" vehicle in Brighton Park. **Page 5**

■ Homeland Security Secretary Kristi Noem says "we're here to stay," indicating ICE may expand in Broadview. **Page 5**

'I don't understand why they do this to us'

Immigrants who thought they were following legal path also are facing deportation under crackdown

By Adriana Pérez
Chicago Tribune

On Sept. 21, Darwin Leal turned 24. His family made him a cake, lit it up with candles and sang him "Happy Birthday" over a video call. He was almost 300 miles away, sharing a cell with dozens of people in a correctional facility in western Michigan.

Just a week earlier on a Sunday, the Venezuelan immigrant had been driving in Chicago's Little Village neighborhood with his wife, 23, and two kids — a 1-year-old boy, Lennyel, and a then-3-year-old

girl, Nicolle — on their way to look at a new place they were hoping to move into, when federal immigration agents stopped the car.

"Darwin? *Salte del vehículo, estás bajo arresto*," an agent could be heard saying in a video filmed by the wife and later shared on social media. "Leave the vehicle, you're under arrest."

"¿Por qué?" the couple asked in unison. "Why?"

"*Estás aquí ilegalmente*," the agent replied. "You're here illegally."

Turn to Immigrants, Page 4



Darwin Leal's wife holds her son Lennyel, 1, on Sept. 23 while talking to her husband by phone. **TERRENCE ANTONIO JAMES/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

In rural southern Illinois, an NPR affiliate tries to persevere amid federal funding cuts



WSIU radio reporter Brian Sapp covers a visit by Bob and Bill Odenkirk to the campus of Southern Illinois University in Carbondale on Sept. 12. **E. JASON WAMBSGANS/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Public radio fighting to survive

By Andrew Carter
Chicago Tribune

CARBONDALE, Ill. — Larry Hunter arrived at the Carbondale Farmers Market on a recent Saturday with an edict from his wife — "don't come home without three tomatoes," she said — and a hope that he could help raise a bit of money, a dollar or five at a time. Maybe it wouldn't make a dent, he knew, but these days anything is something for public media affiliates fighting to survive.

For months, Hunter, interim executive director of WSIU, had grappled with the fallout from the looming budget cuts tied to President Donald Trump's directive to defund public media. Backed by Congress, more than a billion dollars in funding, to be funneled through the Corporation for Public Broadcasting to stations around the country, was disappearing.

The CPB, itself, has announced it will close by the end of the year. An unknown number of National Public

Radio and Public Broadcasting Service television stations face the specter of going silent or dark. And in Carbondale, a city of about 22,000 in rural southern Illinois, where long-established sources of local news and information have already endured blow after blow, Hunter understood the math as well as anyone:

Somehow, he needed to account for the loss of \$1.4 million. And how, exactly?

WSIU's NPR affiliate

Turn to Radio, Page 6

**OCT. 7 ATTACKS
TWO YEARS LATER**

Mourning victims and yearning for peace

Terror and devastation plague those with ties to Israel-Hamas war

By Angie Leventis Lourgos
Chicago Tribune

The horror of the Oct. 7, 2023, Hamas attacks on Israel shocked the world.

In a coordinated large-scale land, sea and air offensive, Hamas fighters launched a surprise incursion on southern Israeli communities and the Tribe of Nova music festival, killing roughly 1,200 people and taking 251 others hostage.

Soon after, Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu declared war on Hamas, vowing "return fire of a magnitude that the enemy has not known."

Israeli airstrikes swiftly rained down on Gaza, spurring an unprecedented humanitarian crisis: More than 66,000 are estimated to have been killed in Gaza and 167,000 have been wounded

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IN NATION & WORLD: Israeli prime minister said he hopes to announce the release of all hostages from Gaza "in the coming days."

INSIDE



CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Brewers take Game 1 with barrage of runs

The Brewers blitz Matthew Boyd for six runs in the first inning, then tack on three more in the second. The Cubs couldn't recover and lose 9-3 in Game 1 of NLDS. **Chicago Sports**

'Greatest recording studio in Chicago'

The city's Chess Records, a legendary label that recorded dozens of blues giants, marks its 75th anniversary. **A+E**

TODAY'S WEATHER

High **86**
Low **65**



Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 22

\$5.75 city and suburbs and elsewhere
178th year No. 278
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